Training: Research Paper and Thesis Writing

Comparison: Thesis vs. Research Article

Aspect	Thesis / Dissertation	Research Article / Paper
Purpose	To fulfill degree requirements (academic qualification).	To share specific research findings with the academic community.
Length	Usually **15,000–80,000 words**, depending on level (BS–MS–PhD).	Typically, **4,000–8,000 words**, concise and focused.
Scope	Covers **broader investigation** of a topic with detailed background, literature, and methodology.	Focuses on **one main problem or study**, summarized precisely.
Audience	Supervisors, examiners, academic committee.	Researchers, journal readers, professionals in the field.
Structure	Contains multiple chapters (Intro, Lit Review, Methodology, Results, Discussion, Conclusion, References, Appendices).	Condensed sections: Abstract, Introduction, Literature Review, Methodology, Results, Discussion, Conclusion, References.
Abstract	Longer (300–500 words), detailed summary of the full study.	Short (150–250 words), concise summary of aims, methods, and findings.
Introduction	Broader background and context; often includes several pages of justification.	Focused introduction linking directly to the research gap and objectives.
Literature Review	Comprehensive, includes **many sources** with detailed analysis.	Selective, includes **only key sources** relevant to the study focus.
Methodology	Highly detailed explanation of methods, instruments, and validation.	Brief and to the point—justifies method choices but avoids lengthy details.
Results & Analysis	May include extensive data, tables, and appendices.	Summarized results—only essential tables and figures.
Supervision & Evaluation	Guided by a **supervisor** and evaluated by internal/external examiners.	**Peer-reviewed** by journal experts before publication.
Publication Status	Usually unpublished (institutional archive or repository).	Published in **academic journals** or conference proceedings.
Contribution	Demonstrates research competence and understanding of methodology.	Contributes **new knowledge** or evidence to existing literature.
Time Duration	Long-term project (months to years).	Short-term project (weeks to months).

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Research: Mind Map Table

Main Part	Sub-Parts / Elements	Explanation / Conceptual Understanding
Title & Abstract	- Title - Abstract – Kev words	**Title:** Concise and specific, reflecting the key idea or variable of the study. **Abstract:** A brief summary (150–250 words) including purpose, method, main findings, and conclusion. **Keywords:** 4–6 key terms that represent the focus areas of the article.
Introduction	1. Background / Context 2. Problem Statement 3. Research Objectives 4. Research Questions / Hypotheses 5. Significance of the Study	1. **Background / Context:** Introduces the topic and its relevance. 2. **Problem Statement:** Identifies the research gap or issue under study. 3. **Objectives:** Defines what the study aims to achieve. 4. **Research Questions / Hypotheses:** Specific questions or hypotheses guiding the paper. 5. **Significance:** Explains why the study matters — academic, social, or professional importance.
Literature Review	1. Theoretical Background 2. Empirical Studies 3. Research Gap	1. **Theoretical Background:** Key theories and models that frame the study. 2. **Empirical Studies:** Review of previous research findings, highlighting patterns or contradictions. 3. **Research Gap:** Clearly identifies what previous studies missed and how this paper addresses it.
Methodology	1. Research Design 2. Population & Sample 3. Data Collection Tools 4. Data Analysis 5. Ethical Considerations	1. **Research Design:** Defines whether the study is qualitative, quantitative, or mixed. 2. **Population & Sample:** Explains who or what was studied. 3. **Data Collection Tools:** Instruments used (e.g., survey, interview, document review). 4. **Data Analysis:** Techniques used for interpretation (thematic analysis, SPSS, coding, etc.). 5. **Ethical Considerations:** Includes consent, confidentiality, and data integrity.
Results & Discussion	- Data Presentation - Interpretation - Comparison with Past Studies	**Results:** Present findings clearly (tables, figures, or text). **Discussion:** Interpret findings in relation to research questions and existing literature, showing what is new or significant.
Conclusion & Recommendations	1. Summary of Key Findings 2. Implications 3. Recommendations 4. Limitations & Future Directions	1. **Summary:** Brief recap of the main outcomes. 2. **Implications:** Theoretical, practical, or policy-level significance. 3. **Recommendations:** Actionable suggestions based on results. 4. **Limitations & Future Directions:** Acknowledge constraints and propose areas for future research.
References	- Citation Style (APA etc.)	Include all sources cited in the article. Follow a consistent and appropriate referencing style (usually APA 7th edition for academic journals).

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Research: Mind Map Table with Examples

#	Domain	Research Title	Research Design (Concept)	Population & Sample (Concept)	Sampling Technique (Concept)	Data Collection Tools (Concept)	Methodology (Concept)	Data Analysis Tools (Concept)
1	**Literature**	Themes of Friendship and Loyalty in *The Merchant of Venice*	**Qualitative Descriptive Design** (explores ideas and messages in the text)	Selected play by Shakespeare	**Purposive Sampling** (selecting one text for detailed study)	**Textual Analysis** (reading and note-taking)	**Literary Analysis** (interpreting key themes and dialogues)	**Thematic Coding** (grouping repeated ideas)
2	**Linguistics**	Common Grammar Mistakes in English Essays of BS Students	**Quantitative Descriptive Design** (collecting and describing data)	BS English 5th & 7th semester students	**Random Sampling** (equal chance selection)	**Students' Written Essays** (document samples)	**Error Analysis** (categorizing grammar errors)	**Frequency Count** (percentages and charts)
3	**Education**	Impact of Teacher Feedback on Student Motivation in Writing	**Correlational Design** (testing link between feedback and motivation)	English students of one college	**Stratified Sampling** (dividing by semester/year)	**Questionnaire** (Likert scale on feedback and motivation)	**Survey Method** (collecting responses from students)	**Pearson Correlation** (measuring relationship)

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4	**Women & Gender**	Representation of Women in English Textbooks	**Qualitative Content Analysis** (analyzing images and descriptions)	English textbooks used in BS programs	**Purposive Sampling** (selecting relevant books)	**Textbook** Content Checklist	**Document Analysis** (examining language and visuals)	**Thematic Frequency** (count of gender portrayals)
5	**Social Media**	Influence of Social Media on Students' Writing Habits	**Quantitative Survey Design** (measuring trends through responses)	BS English students (all semesters)	Convenience Sampling (easily available participants)	Online Questionnaire (Google Form)	Cross-Sectional Survey	**Descriptive Statistics** (mean, percentage, graphs)
6	**Culture & Religion**	Reflection of Islamic Values in Pakistani English Short Stories	**Qualitative Thematic Design** (exploring values in texts)	Selected Pakistani English short stories	**Purposive Sampling** (stories with moral/religious focus)	Textual Reading + Notes	**Thematic Literary Analysis**	**Manual Coding** (highlighting repeated Islamic values)

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Student Worksheet (Filled Example)

Part / Section	Explanation	Topic 1: Representation of Women in English Textbooks	Topic 2: Reflection of Islamic Values in Pakistani English Short Stories
Part 1: Topic & Title Selection			
Research Area	General field of study	Gender Representation in Education	Literature and Culture
Specific Topic	Narrowed topic within the field	Portrayal of Women in English Curriculum Texts	Depiction of Islamic Ethics and Morals in Short Fiction
Tentative Title	Possible title for your article	"Representation of Women in English Textbooks at BS Level"	"Reflection of Islamic Values in Selected Pakistani English Short Stories"
Why I Chose This Topic	Relevance, importance, or personal interest	To explore gender portrayal in learning materials and promote equality awareness	To highlight how Pakistani English writers preserve Islamic and cultural values through literature
Part 2: Introduction			
Background	Context and importance of the topic	Textbooks shape student perceptions; gender bias may influence societal roles.	Literature often mirrors faith and culture; exploring Islamic values enhances moral understanding.
Problem Statement	Issue or gap identified in previous research	Limited studies on gender representation in current English textbooks in Pakistan.	Lack of detailed analysis of moral representation in English short stories written by Pakistani authors.

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Objectives	What this paper intends to achieve	To identify patterns of female representation in selected English textbooks.	To explore the portrayal of Islamic values in modern Pakistani English short stories.
Research Question(s)	Key question(s) to be answered	How are women represented in English textbooks used at the BS level?	How do Pakistani English short stories reflect Islamic moral and spiritual values?
Significance	Why the paper is important (academic/social)	Promotes awareness for curriculum reform and gender balance.	Encourages cultural appreciation and moral reflection in English literature courses.
Part 3: Literature Review			
Key Theories or Models	Main theories related to the topic	Feminist Theory (Simone de Beauvoir), Representation Theory (Stuart Hall)	Moral Literary Criticism, Islamic Literary Perspective
Previous Studies	Mention 3 key studies briefly	1. Analysis of gender bias in school books. 2. Portrayal of women in language textbooks. 3. Role of gender stereotypes in classroom reading.	1. Islamic ideology in South Asian literature. 2. Spiritual themes in Pakistani fiction. 3. Integration of faith and morality in English texts.
Research Gap	What's missing in previous work	Few analyses on BS-level English textbooks used in Pakistani universities.	Limited focus on modern short stories written in English by Pakistani Muslim writers.
Concept Map / Framework	Draw your conceptual link or framework	Women portrayal → Text content → Social message → Curriculum impact	Literary themes → Islamic ethics → Reader moral awareness
Part 4: Methodology			
Research Design	Qualitative / Quantitative / Mixed	Qualitative Content Analysis (text-based interpretation)	Qualitative Thematic Analysis (meaning-based interpretation)

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Population / Sample	Who or what is being studied	BS English Textbooks (selected from Lahore universities)	Selected Pakistani English short stories (e.g., by Bapsi Sidwa, Ahmed Ali, or Shazaf Fatima Haider)
Data Collection Tools	Survey, interview, document analysis, etc.	Document Analysis (text and images in textbooks)	Textual Reading & Note-taking (identifying moral/religious elements)
Data Analysis	How data will be interpreted or presented	Thematic Coding (identifying gender roles and representation)	Thematic Analysis (categorizing Islamic values: honesty, patience, charity, etc.)
Ethical Considerations	Consent, honesty, confidentiality	Fair selection of materials; no misrepresentation	Respect for religious context and author interpretation
Part 5: Results & Discussion			
Expected / Actual Results	Key outcomes of your data	Findings may show imbalance in gender roles or limited female leadership portrayal.	Stories likely reflect Islamic teachings subtly through plot, character, and moral outcomes.
Discussion	How findings answer research questions	Discusses the level and type of female portrayal in academic content.	Explains how literary elements convey Islamic ethics and values.
Interpretation	What the results mean	Indicates curriculum reform is needed for balanced gender representation.	Shows English literature can support cultural and spiritual education.
Part 6: Conclusion & Recommendations			
Summary of Findings	Main insights of the paper	Unequal or limited representation of women in some textbooks.	Islamic values remain integral to Pakistani English literature.

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Conclusion	What you learned or proved	Need for inclusion of gender-balanced and empowering content.	Literature serves as a moral medium, not just artistic expression.
Recommendations	Suggestions for improvement or future research	Revise textbooks to promote balanced representation.	Encourage inclusion of faith-based moral themes in literature courses.
Limitations	Constraints or boundaries of your study	Limited to few selected textbooks from specific universities.	Focused on selected short stories; results not generalizable to all works.
References	APA Style	1. Hall, S. (1997). *Representation: Cultural Representations and Signifying Practices.* 2. Beauvoir, S. (1949). *The Second Sex.* 3. UNESCO Reports on Gender in Education.	1. Ahmed, A. (1940). *Twilight in Delhi.* 2. Islamic Ideology Council (2019). *Ethics in Literature.* 3. Shazaf, F. H. (2013). *How It Happened.*

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Research Paper Writing – Student Worksheet (4 Example Topics)

Part / Section	**Explanation**	**Topic 1: Representation of Women in English Textbooks**	**Topic 2: Reflection of Islamic Values in Pakistani English Short Stories**	**Topic 3: Students' Perception of Teachers' Feedback on Essay Writing**	**Topic 4: Impact of Online Religious Content on Youth Behavior**
Part 1: Topic & Title Selection					
Research Area	General field of study	Gender Studies & Education	Literature & Culture	Educational Psychology	Media & Islamic Studies
Specific Topic	Narrowed topic within the field	Gender portrayal in textbooks	Islamic moral reflection in short fiction	Student response to teachers' written feedback	Influence of online Islamic influencers on ethical choices
Tentative Title	Possible title for your article	"Representation of Women in English Textbooks at BS Level"	"Reflection of Islamic Values in Selected Pakistani English Short Stories"	"Students' Perception of Teachers' Feedback on Essay Writing"	"Impact of Online Religious Content on Youth Behavior and Attitudes"
Why I Chose This Topic	Relevance or interest	Promotes gender awareness in curriculum	Strengthens moral-literary perspective	Improves academic writing and teaching practice	Examines modern media's influence on faith and conduct
Part 2: Introduction					

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Background	Context and importance	Textbooks shape student perceptions	Literature mirrors faith and culture	Feedback helps learning but may be misunderstood	Online sermons shape youth moral behavior
Problem Statement	Gap or issue	Limited analysis of female roles in higher-level textbooks	Few analyses of moral-spiritual themes in Pakistani English literature	Lack of research on students' perception of English feedback	Little research on Islamic media's behavioral influence
Objectives	What to achieve	Identify female representation patterns	Explore Islamic moral portrayal	Examine how students interpret teachers' feedback	Assess influence of online Islamic content on youth
Research Question(s)	Key questions	How are women represented in textbooks?	How are Islamic values reflected in short stories?	How do students perceive and use teachers' written feedback?	How does exposure to Islamic social media affect moral behavior?
Significance	Why important	Promotes equality in learning material	Enhances Islamic-cultural understanding in literature	Improves feedback strategies for teachers	Guides ethical online engagement among youth
Part 3: Literature Review					
Key Theories or Models	Related theories	Feminist & Representation Theories	Islamic Literary & Moral Criticism	Constructivist Learning Theory	Media Influence & Social Learning Theory

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Previous Studies	3 examples	1. Gender bias in language books2. Female roles in school texts3. Textbook content analysis	1. Morality in fiction2. Islamic identity in literature3. Faith-based narratives	1. Feedback and student performance2. Peer review studies3. ESL feedback strategies	1. Media and morality2. Religious influence online3. Youth digital ethics
Research Gap	Missing in prior work	No BS-level textbook analysis	Few English short story studies with Islamic focus	Lack of data on students' emotional reaction to feedback	No comparative study on digital Islamic influence in Pakistan
Concept Map	Link idea chain	Women portrayal → Curriculum → Social effect	Literature → Values → Reader learning	Feedback → Motivation → Improvement	Online content → Faith influence → Ethical actions
Part 4: Methodology					
Research Design	Approach & concept	Qualitative – **Content Analysis** (interpreting text)	Qualitative – **Thematic Analysis** (identifying themes)	Quantitative – **Descriptive Survey Design** (exploring perceptions numerically)	Mixed-Method – **Explanatory Sequential Design** (survey + interviews)
Population / Sample	Who or what is studied	BS English Textbooks (Lahore universities)	Selected Pakistani short stories (by Muslim authors)	BS English students (100 from Lahore colleges)	University students aged 18–25 (social media users)
Sampling Method	Concept	Purposive Sampling (specific texts chosen)	Purposive Sampling (selected works)	Stratified Random Sampling (by semester/year)	Convenience Sampling (based on access)
Data Collection Tools	Instruments used	Document Analysis (content & visuals)	Textual Reading & Note-taking	Questionnaire (Likert-scale)	Online Survey + Semi-structured Interviews

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Data Analysis	Concept	Thematic Coding (recurring gender images)	Thematic Grouping (values & moral lessons)	Descriptive Statistics (mean, % analysis)	Mixed Analysis (SPSS + Narrative Coding)
Ethical Considerations	Integrity & respect	Respectful content interpretation	Cultural sensitivity in moral themes	Voluntary participation, confidentiality	Consent for survey, privacy of online identities
Part 5: Results & Discussion					
Expected Results	Anticipated outcomes	Women underrepresented or stereotyped	Islamic morals positively depicted	Students value positive, detailed feedback	Social media has mixed moral influence
Discussion	Explains findings	Gender balance needs attention	Stories reinforce spiritual awareness	Feedback impacts confidence and writing growth	Faith-based media shapes, but doesn't replace, real mentorship
Interpretation	Meaning	Hidden bias needs reform	Faith is core to national identity	Constructive feedback boosts motivation	Online faith consumption linked to selective morality
Part 6: Conclusion & Recommendations					
Summary of Findings	Main insights	Unequal gender portrayal persists	Strong Islamic moral reflection in fiction	Feedback perception depends on clarity and tone	Balanced Islamic content can promote ethical reflection
Conclusion	What was learned	Curriculum needs gender reform	Literature sustains moral culture	Teachers should adapt feedback style	Religious media can nurture value-based behavior

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Recommendations	Suggestions	Train authors for inclusive writing	Promote moral analysis in English courses	Conduct teacher training on feedback literacy	Create awareness of authentic Islamic sources online
Limitations	Constraints	Limited textbook scope	Limited author selection	Small sample size	Limited to urban students and self-reports
References	APA Style	Hall, S. (1997). *Representation.* Beauvoir, S. (1949). *The Second Sex.*	Ahmed, A. (1940). *Twilight in Delhi.* Shazaf, F. H. (2013). *How It Happened.*	Hyland, K. (2003). *Feedback in Writing.* Ferris, D. (2010). *Responding to Student Writing.*	Bandura, A. (2001). *Social Cognitive Theory of Mass Communication.* Pew Research (2022). *Religion and Media Influence.*